Topic 1 — Early Medieval (प्रारंभिक मध्यकाल) India (Regional Kingdoms)

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Early Medieval India | Major Dynasties of South India | Major Rulers of South India | Pallava (पल्लव) Dynasty | Chalukya (चालुक्य) Dynasty | Western Chalukyas | Rashtrakuta (राष्ट्रकूट) Dynasty | Chola (चोल) Empire | Chola Administration | Chola Local Self-Government | Chola Naval Power | Gurjara-Pratihara Dynasty | Tripartite Struggle (त्रिपक्षीय संघर्ष) for Kannauj (कन्नौज) | Pala Dynasty | Sena Dynasty | Paramara (परमार) Dynasty | Chandela (चंदेल) Dynasty | Gahadavala (गहड़वाल) Dynasty | Kalachuri Dynasty | Hoysala Dynasty | Kakatiya (काकतीय) Dynasty | Yadava (यादव) Dynasty | Medieval Names of Cities of Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश)

Sources baked in: NCERT *Themes in Indian History Part II*, RS Sharma *Medieval India*, Ghatnachakra South India + Pre-Medieval Period, UPPCS Prelims PYQs 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — dynasty↔capital, ruler↔dynasty, temple chronology, Chola A/R, Sena order, UP medieval city names **Last verified:** September 2026 **Current Affairs:** N/A (purely historical; no 12–24 month scheme/appointment surface)

1.1 Early Medieval India

Period: ~**750–1200 CE** (after Harsha; before full Turkish takeover of the north).

- After **Harsha (d. 647)**, no pan-India empire matched Gupta (गुप्त) extent.
- Politics ran through **regional kingdoms**, land grants, and hereditary **samantas** (feudatories).
- **Bhogapatis** and **nad-gavundas** acted as village-level intermediaries and weakened direct royal control over peasants.
- **Brahmanical agrahara** grants were tax-free villages that spread cultivation but also created a new landlord class.
- Northern power rested on the **Ganga (गंगा) valley**, Gujarat, and Malwa.
- Southern power rested on the **Kaveri** (कावेरी), **Krishna**, and **Godavari** (गोदावरी) deltas.
- Sanskrit learning, temple culture, the varna (वर्ण) framework, and guild trade continued in this age.
- The main break from the Gupta era was political fragmentation, not a civilizational collapse.
- In the north, the central theme was the **Tripartite Struggle for Kannauj**.
- In the south, power rotated through the Pallava, Chalukya, Rashtrakuta, and **Chola** cycle.
- **Sulaiman** called the Pala kingdom **Ruhma/Dharma** and praised its elephant corps.
- **Al-Masudi** called the Pratihara realm **Al-Juzr (Gurjara)** and the king **Baura** (likely a garbled form of **Adivaraha** for Mihir Bhoja's line).
- **Araghatta** in economic stems means a water-lifting wheel used to irrigate land (Persian-wheel type), not bonded labour (बंधुआ मज़दूरी) or military land grants.

- This topic covers regional kingdoms and is **not** the Delhi Sultanate, which begins in **1206**.
- A common trap is calling Mihir Bhoja a “Sultan”; he was a Gurjara-Pratihara ruler.

> **Logic:** Early Medieval ends at the Rajput (राजपूत)–Turkish transition (~**Tarain 1192** / **Chandawar 1194**), not at Mughal (मुग़ल) rule.

1.2 Major Dynasties & Rulers of South India

Master match home for dynasty ↔ capital ↔ peak ruler (UPPCS bread-and-butter).

Dynasty	Capital(s)	Region	Key rulers ()
Pallava	**Kanchi**	N. Tamil Nadu / S. Andhra	Mahendravarman I; Narasimhavarman I (**Vatapikonda**)
Early Chalukya	**Badami / Vatapi**	Karnataka–Maharashtra	**Pulakeshin II** (defeated Harsha; Aihole)
Eastern Chalukya	**Vengi** (**Pedavegi** near **Eluru**)	Coastal Andhra (Godavari–Krishna delta (डेल्टा))	**Vishnuvardhana** (branch of Pulakeshin II)
Western Chalukya	**Kalyani**	Deccan	Later Chalukyas; rivalry with Cholas
Rashtrakuta	**Manyakheta** (Malkhed)	Deccan	Dantidurga; **Amoghavarsha I**; Indra III; Krishna I (Ellora (एलोरा))
Chola	**Thanjavur**; later **Gangaikondacholapuram**	Tamil country + overseas	Vijayalaya; **Rajaraja I**; **Rajendra I**
Pandya	**Madurai**	S. Tamil Nadu	**Kadungon** (revival ~6th c.)
Chera	**Vanchi / Karuvur (Karur)**	Kerala coast	Pressured by Chola navy; pepper (काली मिर्च) trade
Hoysala	**Halebid / Dvarasamudra**	Karnataka	**Vishnuvardhana**; Hoysalesvara
Kakatiya	**Warangal** (Orugallu)	Telangana	Ganapati (गणपतिदेव) Deva; **Rudramadevi**
Yadava	**Devagiri** (later Daulatabad)	Maharashtra	Singhana; **Ramachandra**

North & East dynasties (same match-drill home)

Dynasty	Capital / base	Region	Key rulers ()
Pala	Bengal–Bihar seats; Kannauj episodic	East	**Gopala** (elected); **Dharmapala**; **Devapala**

Dynasty	Capital / base	Region	Key rulers ()
Gurjara-Pratihara	**Bhinmal → Kannauj**	Rajasthan–UP–MP	Nagabhatta I; **Mihir Bhoja (Adivaraha)**; Mahendrapala I
Paramara	**Dhara** (earlier Ujjain)	Malwa	**Bhoja I** (scholar-king)
Chandela	**Khajuraho / Mahoba / Kalinjar**	Bundelkhand (**Jejakabhukti**)	**Dhanga**; **Vidyadhara**
Gahadavala	**Kannauj + Banaras**	Eastern UP doab (दोआब)	**Govind Chandra**; **Jay Chandra**
Kalachuri	**Tripuri** (Jabalpur belt)	Chedi / Dahala	**Gangeyadeva**; **Karna**
Sena	**Nadia** (Lakshman Sen)	Bengal	Hemant → Vijaya → Ballal → **Lakshman**
Chauhan (Chahamana)	**Ajmer** (later Delhi)	Rajasthan–Delhi corridor	**Vigraharaja IV**; **Prithviraj III**
Tomar	**Dhillika (Delhi)**	Delhi–Haryana	**Anangpal**
Solanki / Chaulukya	**Anhilwada**	Gujarat	**Mularaja I**; Jayasimha Siddharaja; **Kumarapala**

> **Logic:** Pallava capital is **Kanchi**; Pandya capital is **Madura**; Yadava capital is **Devagiri**; Kakatiya capital is **Warangal**. **Mahendravarman I** was a **Pallava**; **Kadungon** revived the **Pandyas**; **Amoghavarsha I** was a **Rashtrakuta**; **Rajaraja I** was a **Chola**.

PYQs — South dynasties (match)

1. (UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q90) Match List-I (Ruling Dynasties) with List-II (Capitals):

List-I	List-II
A. Pallava	1. Warangal
B. Pandya	2. Kanchi
C. Yadava	3. Madura
D. Kakatiya	4. Devagiri

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A. 2 1 4 3 B. 2 3 4 1 C. 1 2 3 4 D. 2 4 3 1

Show answer

Correct Answer: **B** (2–3–4–1 / A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Pallava → 2. Kanchi:** The Pallavas established their imperial capital at **Kanchipuram** (Kanchi) in northern Tamil Nadu, ruling from the 6th to late 9th century. Kanchi was a renowned centre of Sanskrit and

Tamil learning. - **B. Pandya → 3. Madura:** The Pandyas held their historical capital at **Madurai** (ancient Madura) along the Vaigai river in southern Tamil Nadu, celebrated since the Sangam age and later revived in the 6th century under Kadungon. - **C. Yadava → 4. Devagiri:** The Seuna/Yadava dynasty established their fortified capital at **Devagiri** (later renamed Daulatabad by Muhammad bin Tughlaq) in the northern Deccan (Maharashtra). - **D. Kakatiya → 1. Warangal:** The Kakatiyas ruled the eastern Deccan/Telangana region with their capital at **Warangal** (ancient Orugallu), famous for its four massive stone gateways (*kirti toranas*) and fort walls. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Devagiri is the **Yadava** capital; Warangal is the **Kakatiya** capital. Swapping Devagiri and Warangal is the most frequent UPPCS distractor. - Kanchi (Pallava) and Madurai (Pandya) are the core southern capitals tested in almost every alternate prelims paper.

2. (UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q121) Match List-I (Ruler) with List-II (Dynasty):

List-I	List-II
A. Mahendravarman I	1. Rashtrakuta
B. Kadungon	2. Pallava
C. Amoghavarsha I	3. Chola
D. Rajaraja I	4. Pandya

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A. 4 2 3 1 B. 2 4 1 3 C. 2 4 3 1 D. 4 2 1 3

Show answer

Correct Answer: **B** (2–4–1–3 / A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **A. Mahendravarman I → 2. Pallava:** Early 7th-century Pallava king (c. 600–630 CE), pioneer of rock-cut cave architecture (*Mandagapattu*), gifted musician, and author of the satirical Sanskrit play *Mattavilasa Prahasana*. - **B. Kadungon → 4. Pandya:** Inscriptional hero of the Velvikkudi copper plates who overthrew the Kalabhras around 590 CE and restored the First Pandya Empire at Madurai. - **C. Amoghavarsha I → 1. Rashtrakuta:** Celebrated scholar-king (814–878 CE) of Manyakheta (Malkhed). He was a devout patron of Jainism (under Jinasena) and authored *Kavirajamarga*, the earliest extant landmark in Kannada poetics. - **D. Rajaraja I → 3. Chola:** Peak imperial Chola monarch (985–1014 CE) who commissioned the colossal Brihadishwara Temple at Thanjavur, annexed northern Sri Lanka, and established the Chola naval supremacy. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Do not mistake Kadungon as a Pallava or Chera; he is exclusively tied to the **Pandya revival**. - Amoghavarsha I belongs to the **Rashtrakutas** of Manyakheta, not the Cholas or Chalukyas.

Pandya & Chera (key facts)

- **Kadungon** revived the **Pandya** line around the **6th century**.
- **Kadungon** is the classic Pandya revival ruler paired with the Pandya dynasty.
- Later Pandyas ruled from **Madurai** and repeatedly clashed with Cholas for Tamil supremacy.

- **Rajaraja I** conquered Madurai.
- **Parantaka I** earlier defeated the Madurai king and took the title **Maduraikonda**.
- Pandya revival came again only after Chola decline.
- Tradition links the original **Meenakshi** shrine at Madurai with **Kulasekara Pandya**; the city is remembered as lotus-shaped around the temple.
- The **Cheras** drew wealth from **Malabar coast** trade in pepper and spices.
- Chera capital memory is **Vanchi / Vanji / Karuvur (Karur)** — not Puducherry.
- **Rajaraja I** destroyed the Chera navy at **Kandalloor / Trivandrum**, ending their maritime challenge.

1.3 Pallava Dynasty

Capital:Kanchi (Kanchipuram (कांचीपुरम)) | Span: c. **575–897 CE | Rival:** Early Chalukyas of Badami

- **Simhavishnu (c. 575–600)** is treated as the dynastic restorer who made Kanchi the Pallava power centre. He took the title **Avanisimha (Avanisingh)** and defeated Chola, Pandya, Sinhala, and Kalabhra rivals.
- **Mahendravarman I (c. 600–630)** pioneered **rock-cut** (शैल-कट) architecture at Mahabalipuram and is a classic **Pallava** ruler.
- **Mahendravarman I** patronised Shaivism (शैव), Vaishnavism (वैष्णव), and Jainism (जैन धर्म) and wrote the Sanskrit humorous play ***Mattavilasa Prahasana***.
- **Narasimhavarman I (c. 630–668)** took the title **Mahamalla** (great wrestler). He took **Vatapi in 642** and earned the title **Vatapikonda**. The famous **Pancha Rathas** belong to his Mamalla phase.
- In **642** he sent **two naval expeditions** to Ceylon to help a Sri Lankan prince.
- **Parameshvaravarman I (c. 670–700)** carried titles such as Lokaditya, Ekamalla, Rananjaya, Ugradanda, and related warrior epithets.
- **Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha)** built the structural (संरचनात्मक) **Shore Temple** at **Mahabalipuram** (महाबलीपुरम).
- **Nandivarman II (c. 731–795)** belongs to the later Pallava phase before Chola eclipse of Kanchi prestige.
- Pallava chronological spine for arrange stems: **Mahendravarman I → Narasimhavarman I → Parameshvaravarman I → Nandivarman II**.
- Pallava art moved from rock-cut caves (Mahendravarman) to monolith rathas (Mamalla) to structural stone temples (Rajasimha).
- The Pallava–Chalukya rivalry centred on the **Krishna–Tungabhadra (तुंगभद्रा) doab**.
- Both sides fought for control of **Vatapi** and **Kanchi**.

> **Logic:** Shore Temple = **Pallava**, not Chola. Do not swap **Kanchi** with **Kannauj**. **Mahamalla ≠ Chola**.

PYQ — Temple chronology (Pallava + Chola)

1. (UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q15) Arrange the following temples chronologically:

I. Brihdishwar temple

II. Gangaikonda cholapuram (गंगैकोंड चोलपुरम) temple

III. Shore temple of Mahabalipuram

IV. Sapt pagoda

A. I, II, IV, III B. II, I, III, IV C. III, II, I, IV D. IV, III, I, II

Show answer

Correct Answer: **D** (IV, III, I, II) **Detailed Explanation:** The correct chronological order from earliest to latest is: 1. **IV. Sapt Pagoda (Pancha Rathas, Mahabalipuram):** Monolithic rock-cut shrines carved during the reign of Pallava king **Narasimhavarman I 'Mahamalla'** (c. **630–668 CE**). These represent the earliest monolithic rock-cut phase of Dravidian architecture. 2. **III. Shore Temple of Mahabalipuram:** One of the earliest free-standing structural stone temples in South India, built by Pallava king **Narasimhavarman II 'Rajasimha'** (c. **700–728 CE**). 3. **I. Brihadishwara Temple at Thanjavur:** Grand structural Dravidian granite temple completed by Imperial Chola monarch **Rajaraja I** in **1010 CE** (11th century). 4. **II. Gangaikondacholapuram Temple:** Built by Rajaraja's son and successor, **Rajendra I**, around **1035 CE** (c. 1025–1035 CE) to commemorate his triumphant northern campaign to the holy river Ganga. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Rajaraja I (father) built Thanjavur **before** Rajendra I (son) built Gangaikondacholapuram. - Sapt Pagoda (rock-cut monoliths) preceded the Shore Temple (masonry/structural), though both are Pallava monuments at Mahabalipuram.

1.4 Chalukya Dynasty & Western Chalukyas



Early Chalukyas:Badami / Vatapi (c. **543–757**) | **Western / Later Chalukyas:Kalyani** (c. **973–1189**)

Feature	Early (Badami)	Western (Kalyani)
Capital	**Badami / Vatapi**	**Kalyani**
Peak ruler	**Pulakeshin II**	Vikramaditya VI (high-water mark)
Main rival	**Pallavas**	**Cholas** (Vengi + Tungabhadra doab)

Feature	Early (Badami)	Western (Kalyani)
End	Overthrown by **Rashtrakutas** (**757**)	Pressed by Hoysalas, Yadavas, later Sultanate

- **Pulakeshin I** was the real founder of the **Vatapi / Badami** Chalukya dynasty. **Kirtivarman I** and Mangalesha built the early Badami base before Pulakeshin II's fame.
- Present **Badami** (बादामी) (Bagalkot district, Karnataka) is ancient **Vatapi**, Chalukya capital in the 6th–7th centuries.
- **Pulakeshin II (610–642)** was the most capable Early Chalukya ruler. He stopped **Harsha** near the **Narmada** (नर्मदा).
- The **Aihole inscription** of **Ravikirti** (रविकीर्ति) praises Pulakeshin II. At the end of the prasasti, Ravikirti claims fame like **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) and **Bharavi** (भारवि) — so **Kalidasa's name** appears in the Aihole record.
- **Vikramaditya I** recovered Badami after the Pallava sack of Vatapi.
- **Vikramaditya II** captured Kanchi and patronised the **Virupaksha (विरूपाक्ष) temple at Pattadakal (पट्टदकल)**.
- Eastern Chalukyas of **Vengi** were founded by **Kubja Vishnuvardhana**, a brother / branch line of **Pulakeshin II**, after the Badami conquest of coastal Andhra.
- The capital **Vengi** (also **Vengipura**) is identified with **Pedavegi** (Peddavegi), a village near **Eluru** in **West Godavari** district, Andhra Pradesh — not with Badami, Kalyani, or Amaravati (अमरावती).
- The kingdom's name stayed **Vengi** even when a later Eastern Chalukya centre rose at **Rajamahendravaram** (modern **Rajahmundry** (राजमहेन्द्रवरम)).
- Later Chola–Western Chalukya rivalry repeatedly turned on **Vengi** and the **Tungabhadra doab**.
- **Pattadakal** (पट्टदकल) (UNESCO) marks the Early Chalukya architectural peak.
- The queen **Lokmahadevi** built the **Virupaksha temple** at Pattadakal.
- Chalukyas frequently appointed **women** to high administrative posts. **Vijaya Bhattarika**, queen of Chandraditya (brother of Vikramaditya I), issued copper plates in her own name and ran administration efficiently; she was also a poetess. A royal sister **Kumkumadevi** could recommend (सिफारिश) a village grant to a learned Brahmana.
- Chinese writer **Matwalin (Ma-twalin)** gives an account of China–India relations in the Chalukya age.
- Chalukya origin legends claim **Agnikula** descent from **Ayodhya** (अयोध्या).
- That Ayodhya link is a UP-linked trap in Rajput-origin questions.

Kadamba (neighbour fact)

- The **Kadamba** capital was **Vanavasi**.
- The dynasty was founded by **Mayurasharman**.
- **Pulakeshin II** annexed the Kadamba state.
- Kadambas are **not** a Sangam (संगम) Muvendar (मुवेन्दर) house.

> **Logic note:** Badami ≠ Kalyani ≠ Vengi. If the option says "Western Chalukya capital = Vatapi," it is wrong. **Vanavasi = Kadamba**, not Chalukya. **Eastern Chalukya Vengi = Pedavegi near Eluru** — do not pick Rajahmundry as the original capital identification.

PYQ — Western Chalukya vs Chola

1. Assertion (A): The **Western Chalukyas of Kalyani** repeatedly fought the **Cholas**.

Reason (R): Control of **Vengi** and the **Tungabhadra doab** was strategically valuable to both.

A. Both true, R explains A B. Both true, R not explanation C. A true, R false D. A false, R true

Show answer

Correct Answer: **A** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** The Western Chalukyas of Kalyani (founded by Tailapa II in 973 CE) and the Imperial Cholas of Thanjavur engaged in relentless, multi-generational warfare throughout the 11th and 12th centuries (e.g. battles of Maski, Kudal-Sangamam, and Koppam). - **Reason (R) is correct:** Two prime geopolitical flashpoints fueled this continuous warfare: 1. **Control of Vengi (Eastern Chalukya kingdom):** The Cholas maintained marital and political alliances with Vengi (which culminated in the Chola-Chalukya union under Kulottunga I), whereas the Western Chalukyas viewed Vengi as their rightful sphere of influence. 2. **The fertile Krishna–Tungabhadra Doab (Raichur doab):** This rich agricultural and mineral tract formed the contested borderland buffer between the northern Deccan and the deep South. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The strategic compulsion to monopolize the fertile river valleys of the Tungabhadra doab and dominate the maritime outlets of the Godavari–Krishna delta at Vengi was the fundamental economic and geopolitical cause that provoked repeated military clashes between both empires. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Badami/Vatapi Chalukyas fought the **Pallavas** (6th–8th c.). - Kalyani/Western Chalukyas fought the **Cholas** (10th–12th c.). Never interchange these dynastic rival pairs.

1.5 Rashtrakuta Dynasty



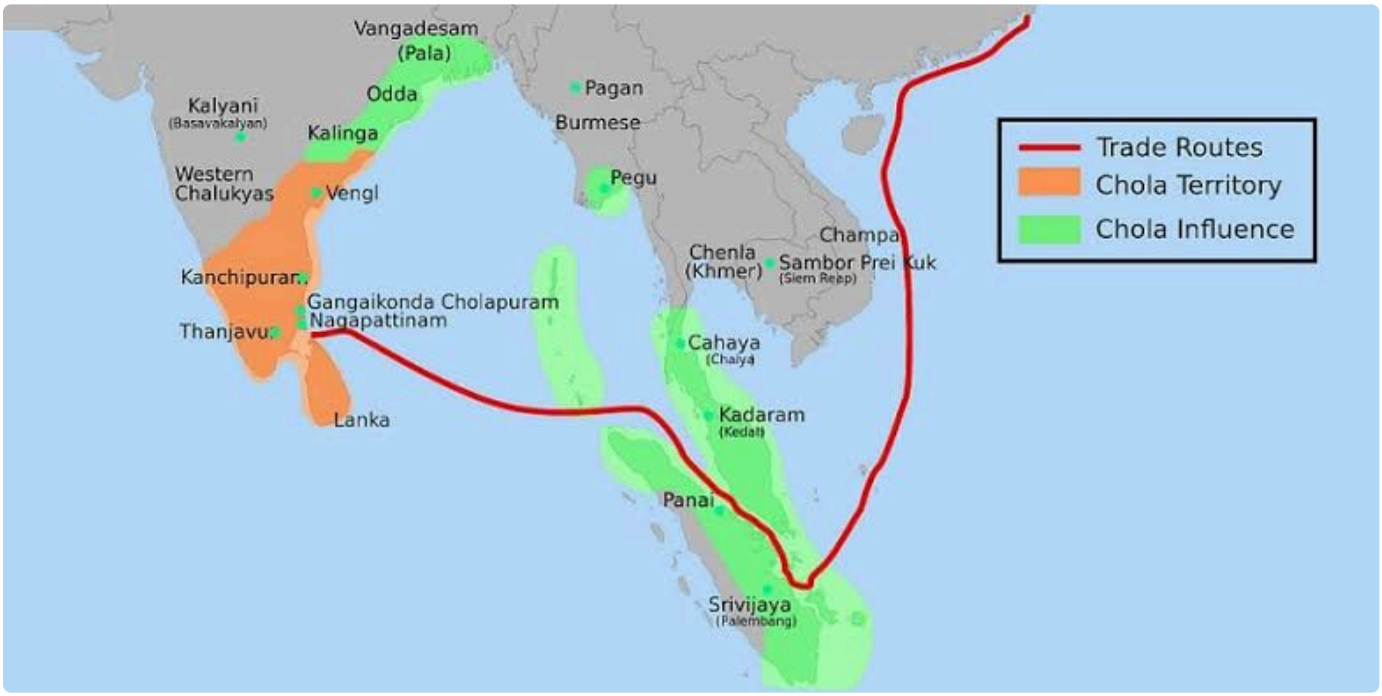
Capital:Manyakheta (Malkhed) | **Founder:Dantidurga** (overthrew Early Chalukyas **757**) | **Span:** c. **753–972**

- **Dantidurga** laid the Rashtrakuta foundation and is remembered for the **Hiranyagarbha** ritual (कर्मकाण्ड) at **Ujjain**.
- **Krishna I** commissioned the monolithic **Kailasa (कैलास) temple at Ellora**.
- **Amoghavarsha I (814–878)** ruled for about **64 years**.
- He was born in a military camp near the **Narmada** while his father **Govinda III** returned from northern campaigns.
- He wrote **Kavirajamarga**, an early Kannada text.
- **Amoghavarsha I** is the classic **Rashtrakuta** ruler paired with Manyakheta.
- **Govinda III** campaigned north against Pratiharas and south against Tamil powers. He defeated Pratihara **Nagabhatta II** (Sanjan / Radhanpur plates).

- **Indra III** sacked **Kannauj (915–918)** in the tripartite contest.
- **Krishna III** defeated Chola **Parantaka I** (**949**) and reached Rameshwaram.
- **Krishna III** erected a **victory pillar at Rameshwaram** after the southern campaign.
- Al-Masudi called the Rashtrakuta emperor **Balhara / Vallabharaja**.
- **Chandrobalabbe**, daughter of Amoghavarsha I, administered the **Raichur doab**.
- Rashtrakuta provinces were called **rashtra**.
- Districts within them were **visaya**, forming a samanta-like feudal layer.
- The Rashtrakutas patronised Shaivism, Vaishnavism, and Jainism and tolerated Muslim traders in their ports.
- The empire ended when Manyakheta fell in **972**.
- Western Chalukyas rose in its place.

> **Logic:** Amoghavarsha I = Rashtrakuta (not Chola/Pallava). **Hiranyagarbha** = Dantidurga. Manyakheta is not a Pratihara capital.

1.6 Chola Empire



Founder:Vijayalaya took **Thanjavur ~850** | **Span:** c. **850–1279** | **Peak:Rajaraja I (985–1014)** and **Rajendra I (1014–1044)**

- After the Sangam Cholas there is a long interregnum until the medieval Cholas rise under **Vijayalaya**.
- **Vijayalaya** began as a Pallava feudatory before capturing Tanjore and founding the imperial Chola line in the **9th century**.
- **Aditya I** defeated the Pallavas and expanded Chola power in the Tamil core.

- **Parantaka I** defeated the Madurai king and assumed the title **Maduraikonda**. He pushed Chola borders northward.
- Chola emperors generally designated a **Yuvraj** (heir) during their own reign.

Battle of Takkolam (949) — Cause, Course, Result

Place: Takkolam | **Chola side:** prince **Rajaditya**, son of **Parantaka I** | **Opponent:** Rashtrakuta **Krishna III** with Western Ganga and related allies

- **Cause:** Chola expansion under Parantaka I collided with Rashtrakuta ambitions in the Tamil–Deccan frontier.
- **Course:** At **Takkolam in 949**, Krishna III's confederacy fought Rajaditya. The Chola prince was **killed on the battlefield**.
- **Result:** The Cholas were defeated and lost northern holdings for a generation. Krishna III later reached Rameshwaram and raised a victory pillar. Chola recovery waited until after Rashtrakuta collapse (**972**).
- After Rashtrakuta collapse (**972**), Cholas re-emerged as the dominant south Indian power.
- The golden age opens with **Rajaraja I**. He was the first Chola king to organise a standing **naval army (सेना)**.
- **Rajaraja I** defeated the Chera naval force at **Kandalloor**, conquered **northern Sri Lanka** (Anuradhapura destroyed; the south remained independent for a time), took the **Maldives**, and conquered Madurai.
- **Rajaraja I** and his son **Rajendra I** sent expeditions against the **Sailendra / Srivijaya** world of Southeast Asia when trade toward China was obstructed.
- **Rajaraja I** built **Brihadishwara (Rajarajesvaram) at Tanjore in 1010** — a peak **Dravida** (द्रविड़) granite temple with two **dvarapalas** and a colossal single-rock **Nandi** among the tallest in India.
- **Rajendra I** completed the conquest of **whole Sri Lanka** and brought Sinhala king **Mahendra V** as a prisoner.
- **Rajendra I** defeated Pala ruler **Mahipala**, took the title **Gangaikondachola**, and founded the new capital **Gangaikondacholapuram**.
- He built the artificial lake **Chola Gangam (Ponneri)** in memory of the Ganga-basin victory that included Bengal and Kalinga (कलिंग) kings.
- The Chola navy was the strongest in the region and turned the Bay of Bengal into a "**Chola Lake**."
- Rajendra's **1025** naval war hit **Srivijaya** and **Kadaram (Kedah)** after trade obstruction.
- Chola artists excelled in stone and especially **bronze** (कांस्य). The classic **Nataraja** (dancing Shiva) icons have **four hands**. In the right ear he wears a man's earring and in the left a woman's — the **Ardhanarishwara** hint.
- The **Dakshinamurti** form of Shiva shows him as **guru (गुरु) / teacher** giving knowledge to devotees. The image is installed facing **south**.
- Chola rulers cut **victory narratives on temple walls** and issued copper plates.
- That is why sources for the Cholas outrun earlier Tamil dynasties.
- **Kulottunga I** consolidated Chola power. In **1077** a Chola mission of **72** merchants / Buddhist traders was sent to **China**.

- When **Vijayabahu** proclaimed an independent Sinhala island in Kulottunga's time, Kulottunga did not escalate hostility and married his daughter to Sinhala prince **Virapperumal**.
- The empire later cracked under Pandya–Hoysala–Kakatiya pressure. Near **1279** Chola power ended under **Rajendra III**; Malik Kafur's southern campaigns come later (~**1310**).

> **Logic: Rajaraja I** built **Brihadishwara (1010)** before **Rajendra I** built **Gangaikondacholapuram (~1025)**. **Rajaraja I** was a **Chola** ruler. Chola founder = **Vijayalaya**, not Parantaka.

PYQ — Chola sources

1. (UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q8)Assertion (A): We have much more information about Cholas than their predecessors.

Reason (R): The Chola rulers adopted (अंगीकृत) the practice of having inscriptions written on the walls of temples giving a historical narrative of their victories.

A. Both true and R explains A B. Both true, R not explanation C. A true, R false D. A false, R true

Show answer

Correct Answer: **A** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Historians possess far more detailed, accurate, and chronologically consistent information about the Chola Empire than any of their South Indian predecessors (such as the Pallavas, early Pandyas, or Cheras). - **Reason (R) is correct:** Starting with Rajaraja I (985–1014 CE), the Chola administration institutionalized the practice of engraving formal historical introductions (*Meikeerthi* or *Prasasti*) directly on temple stone walls before recording any royal grant, donation, or decree. These inscriptions systematically documented the king's conquests, genealogy, administrative reforms, village boundaries, and tax assessments. - **Why (R) explains (A):** Because large stone temples (like the Brihadishwara temples at Thanjavur and Gangaikondacholapuram) served as virtually indestructible public archives, thousands of preserved epigraphs provide an exceptionally rich, verifiable primary source base for the Cholas that does not survive for earlier dynasties. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Rajaraja I was the innovator of the royal *Meikeerthi* (formal historical prologue) on temple walls. - Do not assume that earlier dynasties like the Pallavas left more written records simply because they built rock-cut shrines earlier; the Cholas left vastly superior quantities of descriptive historical inscriptions.

1.7 Chola Administration

Hierarchy: King → **Mandalam** (province) → **Kottam / Valanadu** → **Nadu** → **Kurram** / village → **Gram Sabha** (ग्राम सभा).

- At peak the empire is often counted with about **four** great **mandalam** provinces — roughly **Tondaimandalam**, **Cholamandalam**, **Pandimandalam**, and **Gangapadi / Kongumandalam** (some handbooks count up to six provincial divisions).
- A province was divided into **Kottam** or **Valanadu** (commissionerate-like units).
- Each Kottam held several **Nadu** (districts). The assembly of a Nadu was the **Nattar**.

- The village association could be called **Kurram**. The smallest unit was the **Gram Sabha**.
- Land revenue was the fiscal core of Chola finance.
- Village-level surveys and **kudimai / karai** dues funded the state.
- **Brahmadeya** villages were Brahmana settlements.
- **Devadana** villages were temple-endowment lands.
- Officials and **agrahara** holders acted as intermediaries between the king and cultivating peasants.
- The standing army had separate **elephant**, **cavalry**, and **infantry** corps.
- The navy was a distinct strategic arm.
- Temple institutions stored land, cash, and inscription records.
- Administration and religion were tightly linked through these temple networks.

> **Logic:** Nadu is the basic territorial unit below Valanadu; **Mandalam** is the province. Do not reverse them.

1.8 Chola Local Self-Government

Special feature of the Chola age: systematic **autonomy of village administration**.

Body / board	Who / meaning	Role
Ur	General village assembly	Ordinary (non-agrahara) villages
Sabha / Mahasabha	Brahmana assembly in **agrahara** villages	Higher autonomy; committee system
Variyam	Working committee of the Sabha	Supervised village executive work
Thotta Variyam (तोट्टा)	Garden / horticulture board	Gardens and groves
Samvatsara Variyam	Annual committee	Yearly oversight
Eri Variyam (एरी)	Tank committee	Lakes, tanks, water supply
Pon Variyam	Gold / finance committee	Precious metal and money matters

- The **Uttaramerur** inscription archives how the executive committee of the Gram Sabha worked. Every such village had its own **Sabha** (सभा), largely independent of central command for local affairs.
- Many committee tenures used **lottery / kudavolai** selection instead of open hereditary office.
- Membership tests covered property, age, learning, and character.
- Local bodies collected dues, maintained tanks, and managed temple lands under royal oversight.

Related land / college terms (high-yield pairs):

Term	Meaning
Eripatti	Land whose revenue was set apart for maintenance of the **village tank**

Term	Meaning
Taniyur	A **very large village** administered as a single unit (not “land gifted to one Brahmana”)
Ghatika	A college generally attached to a temple

> **Logic:** Ur ≠ Sabha. **Sabha = Brahmana agrahara assembly with stronger autonomy.** Taniyur ≠ Brahmadeya gift** in the usual wrong-pair stem.

1.9 Chola Naval Power



Peak under Rajaraja I and Rajendra I | Bay of Bengal nicknamed “Chola Lake”

Target	Ruler	Fact
Sri Lanka	Rajaraja I, then Rajendra I	Northern then full-island control; Mahendra V prisoner under Rajendra
Maldives	**Rajaraja I**	Western sea lanes
Chera fleet	**Rajaraja I**	Defeat at **Kandalloor**
Srivijaya / **Kadaram (Kedah)**	**Rajendra I, 1025**	Malay / Sumatra trade choke
China embassies / missions	Chola court	**1016, 1033, 1077** (72 traders under **Kulottunga I**, 1077)

- Merchant guilds (श्रेणी) such as **Manigramam**, **Nanadesi** (नानादेशी), and **Valanjiyar** backed long-distance trade.

- **Nagapattinam** served as a major Chola port with Buddhist monastery links to Southeast Asia.
- Naval power aimed to secure **Indian Ocean trade** in spices, textiles, ivory, and horses.
- Rajendra I attacked **Srivijaya** in **1025** because Chola merchants faced trade obstruction there.
- The Bay of Bengal was nicknamed **“Chola Lake”** during this maritime supremacy.
- Later Arab and Chinese shipping reduced Indian dominance in the Indian Ocean.
- The Chola navy was the first Indian empire to project **sustained naval power beyond the subcontinent**.

> **Logic:**1025 Kadaram / Srivijaya **=** Rajendra I**, not Rajaraja. “Chola Lake” =** Bay of Bengal**. First standing naval army =** Rajaraja I**.

PYQ — “Chola Lake”

1. Assertion (A): The **Bay of Bengal** was called **“Chola Lake”** in the imperial Chola age.

Reason (R): **Rajendra I's** naval campaigns secured dominance over Bay of Bengal trade lanes including **Kadaram**.

A. Both true, R explains A B. Both true, R not explanation C. A true, R false D. A false, R true

Show answer

Correct Answer: **A** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** Contemporaries and modern historians frequently refer to the **Bay of Bengal** as a **"Chola Lake"** during the 11th century, reflecting the unprecedented total naval dominance exercised by the Chola fleet over its waters. - **Reason (R) is correct:** In **1025 CE**, Emperor **Rajendra I** launched an audacious trans-oceanic naval expedition across the Bay of Bengal against the maritime empire of **Srivijaya** (Sumatra/Java) and sacked key ports including **Kadaram (modern Kedah in Malaysia)**, Pannai, and Malaiyur. This secured the vital sea lanes through the Malacca Strait toward Song Dynasty China and eliminated piracy and trade blockades against Tamil merchant guilds (*Manigramam*, *Nanadesi*). - **Why (R) explains (A):** By holding coastal control over Ceylon (Sri Lanka), the Maldives, the Coromandel coast, coastal Bengal/Odisha, and the strategic straits of Southeast Asia, the Chola navy effectively transformed the Bay of Bengal into an internal, undisputed imperial waterway ("lake"). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - The overseas expedition to Kadaram and Srivijaya was launched in **1025 CE** by **Rajendra I**, not Rajaraja I. - The term "Chola Lake" applies strictly to the **Bay of Bengal**, not the Arabian Sea or the Indian Ocean as a whole.

1.10 Gurjara-Pratihara Dynasty



Early base:Bhinmal / Ujjain | Capital under Mihir Bhoja:Kannauj (Mahodaya / Mahodaya Shri) | Span: 8th–10th c.

- **Pratihara** means “doorkeeper” in Rajput **Agnikula** legend.
- The Pratiharas are counted among the four fire-born clans in that tradition.
- **Nagabhatta I (730–756)** is often listed as dynastic founder who resisted **Arab** pressure from Sind (सिंध) (Gwalior inscription tradition).
- **Vatsaraja (c. 775–800)** is the consolidator who made the house a real imperial power in the tripartite age.
- Chronology spine: **Vatsaraja** → **Nagabhatta II** → **Mihir Bhoja** → **Mahendrapala I** → **Mahipala**.
- **Nagabhatta II** defeated **Dharmapala** near **Mongyr (Munger)** and revived Pratihara power in the doab.
- **Mihir Bhoja (Adivaraha / Prabhasa, ~836–885)** recovered **Kannauj around 836** and made it capital.
- Arab traveller **Sulaiman** visited in the reign of **Bhoja I (Mihir Bhoja)**.
- **Al-Masudi** praised Pratihara cavalry and called the king **Baura** (linked to the **Adivaraha** title).

- **Mahendrapala I (885–910)** extended the empire into Magadha (मगध), north Bengal, and Awadh (अवध).
- **Mahipala (912–944)** lost Kannauj to **Indra III**.
- Sanskrit poet **Rajasekhara** adorned the courts of **Mahendrapala I** and his son **Mahipala I**.
- His works include *Karpuramanjari*, *Kavyamimamsa*, *Viddhashalabhanjika*, *Balaramayana*, and related texts. He is a **poet**, not a jurist.
- Early medieval jurists are **Vijnaneshwara** (*Mitakshara*), **Jimutavahana** (*Dayabhaga*), and **Hemadri**.
- Pratihara courts sent mathematical and medical texts to **Baghdad**, showing wide cultural contact.
- **Kanauj school** of temple architecture flourished under Pratihara patronage.
- **Krishna III (Rashtrakuta)** invaded again in **963**, hastening Pratihara collapse.
- Feudatories later became **Paramaras**, **Chandelas**, and **Chauhans** as the empire cracked.

> **Logic:** Mihir Bhoja = Pratihara (title **Adivaraha**). Not the same person as **Paramara Bhoja** of Dhara. Kannauj = **Mahodaya / Mahodaya Shri**.

1.11 Tripartite Struggle for Kannauj

Tripartite Struggle — Cause, Course, Result (overview)



Actors:Palas (east), **Gurjara-Pratiharas** (west), **Rashtrakutas** (south) | **Prize:Kannauj** symbolic capital

Cause: After Harsha's empire, **Kannauj** became the prestige seat of north Indian kingship. Three regional powers fought to control it and the **doab** (दोआब) trade routes. **Course:** Dharmapala **installed a Pala nominee at Kannauj.** Mihir Bhoja **(Pratihara) recovered the city.** Dhruva **and** Govinda III **(Rashtrakutas) raided north and temporarily held Kannauj;** Indra III **famously sacked it.** Result: **No single power permanently united India. The struggle weakened all three and left the** Gangetic plain **open to later** Turkish **breakthroughs after** Pratihara** decline.

Three powers:Pala (Bengal–Bihar) + **Gurjara-Pratihara** (Rajasthan–UP) + **Rashtrakuta** (Deccan) | **Prize:Kannauj** (post-Harsha sovereignty symbol)

Actor	Move
Dharmapala (Pala)	Occupied Kannauj and installed **Chakrayudha** as nominee
Mihir Bhoja (Pratihara)	Recovered Kannauj; held it as capital

Actor	Move
Indra III (Rashtrakuta)	**Sacked Kannauj 915–918** and defeated **Mahipala**
Krishna III (Rashtrakuta)	Later northern raid **963** that further weakened Pratiharas

- The struggle ran roughly from the **8th to 10th centuries**.
- No lasting pan-India winner emerged from it.
- **Cholas were not** a fourth Kannauj contestant.
- Kannauj mattered because it was Harsha's old capital and a symbol of **Ganga-doab sovereignty**.
- After Pratihara decline, **Gahadavalas** later held Kannauj + Banaras in the UP doab.

> **Logic:** Tripartite = **exactly three**. Swap-trap: adding Chola or Chauhan as a main Kannauj player.

1.12 Pala Dynasty



Region:Bengal + Bihar | **Founder:Gopala (~750)**, elected by chiefs after anarchy | **Span:** mid-8th to mid-12th c.

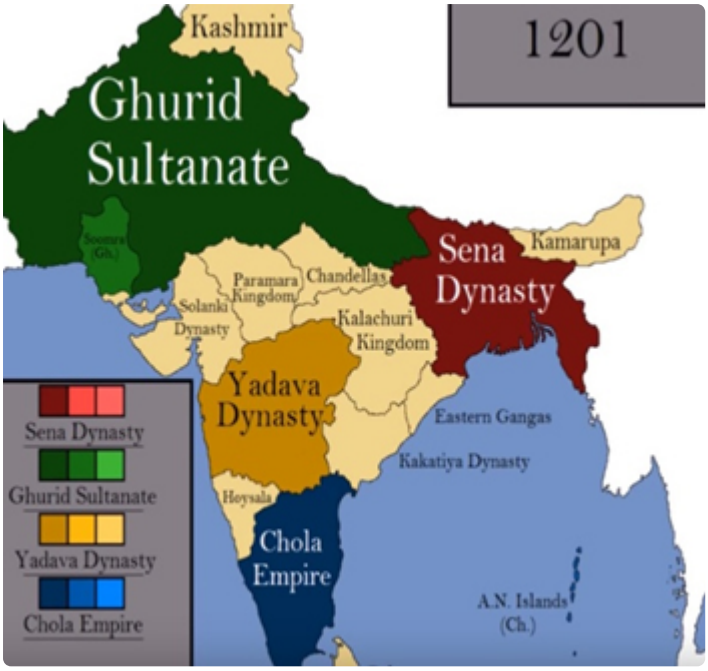
- **Gopala (~750–770)** was chosen by local chiefs to end **matsyanyaya** (law of the jungle), recorded in the Khalimpur tradition of Dharmapala.
- Tibetan memory (Taranatha) links his birth near **Pundravardhana**.
- He is the major **elected medieval founder** fact, often paired with Pallava **Nandivarman Pallavamalla** as another publicly chosen king.
- **Gopala** founded / developed the **Odantapuri (Odantapura)** educational centre in **Bihar**.
- **Dharmapala (770–810)** entered the tripartite war for Kannauj and occupied the city.
- Inscriptions call him **Paramasaugata** (devoted Buddhist).
- He revived **Nalanda** (नालंदा) and founded **Vikramashila** (Bhagalpur, Bihar — not Banka).
- He also built the great monastery at **Somapura / Somapuri (Paharpur)**.
- Haribhadra and other Buddhist scholars are linked with his court; tradition credits many religious schools without religious persecution of others.
- **Devapala (810–850)** marked the territorial peak with Assam, Odisha, and Nepal contacts. He too is remembered as **Paramasaugata**.
- At the request of **Sailendra** king **Balaputradeva** of Suvarnadvipa / Java, Devapala granted **five villages** to maintain a Buddhist vihara at **Nalanda**.
- **Pundravardhana bhukti** lay in **north Bengal** and later stretched into northern Bihar under Pala–Chandra–Sena rule.
- Sulaiman called the Pala realm **Ruhma/Dharma** and praised its elephant corps.
- The Palas were great **Buddhist patrons** who also granted Brahmana villages and supported Shaivism/Vaishnavism.
- **Santarakshita** and **Atisha (Dipankara)** linked Pala Buddhism to **Tibet**. Vajrayana (वज्रयान) flourished at Vikramashila alongside grammar, logic, law, astronomy, and philosophy.
- **Mahipala (~988–1038)** briefly revived Pala power before Sena takeover in Bengal.
- Early medieval learning centres of this belt are **Nalanda**, **Vikramashila**, and **Odantapuri**. **Taxila** (तक्षशिला) belongs to an earlier age and is **not** an early-medieval Pala centre.
- **Bakhtiyar Khalji (खिलजी)** destroyed **Nalanda** and **Vikramashila** in the early **13th century** after Pala–Sena rule ended.

Mithila neighbour (Karnata line)

- In the Mithila / north Bihar belt, the **Karnata** dynasty was founded by **Nanyadeva (c. 1097–1147)** with capital at **Simraungadh**.
- The last major Karnata king was **Harisimha (c. 1295–1324)**, remembered for protecting arts and starting the **Panji** system.

> **Logic:** Gopala = elected founder + Odantapuri**.** Vikramashila / Somapura = Dharmapala**.** **Balaputradeva = Sailendra request under** Devapala**.

1.13 Sena Dynasty



Region:Bengal (11th–13th c.) | **Founder line:Samanta (सामंत) Sena** | **Capital under Lakshman:Nadia (Navadwip)**

Order (ascending)	Ruler	Fact
1	**Hemant Sen**	Starts the 2024 chain
2	**Vijaya Sen**	Defeated late Palas and consolidated Bengal
3	**Ballal Sen**	Compiled **Danasagara** on gifts; pushed Brahmanical orthodoxy
4	**Lakshman Sen**	Patronised **Jayadeva** (जयदेव); started **Lakshmana Samvat**; fled **Bakhtiyar Khalji (1204)**

- The Senas claimed a Karnataka / Kshatriya origin before entering Bengal as Palas weakened.
- Full inscriptional line often runs Samanta → Hemanta → Vijaya → Ballala → Lakshmana → Visvarupa.
- **Vijaya Sen** expanded Sena power into **Bengal and part of Bihar**.
- **Ballal Sen** strengthened caste orthodoxy and Sanskrit learning at the cost of Pala-style Buddhism. He compiled **Danasagara**.
- **Lakshmana Sena (c. 1178–1206)** reigned about **28 years** and initiated **Lakshmana Samvat**.
- **Jayadeva**, author of **Gita Govinda** (गीत गोविंद), belonged to **Lakshman Sen's** court at Nadia.
- **Muhammad Bakhtiyar Khalji** captured **Nadia in 1204** after entering disguised as a horse merchant.
- Lakshman Sen fled, marking the start of Turkish rule in Bengal.
- Sena administration followed earlier Pala models of land grants to Brahmins.

> **Logic:** Sena ruler order is **Hemant** → **Vijaya** → **Ballal** → **Lakshman**. **Lakshmana Samvat** belongs to

> the **Sena** dynasty, not Pala or Pratihara.

PYQ — Sena chronology

1. (UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q3) Arrange the Sen rulers of Bengal in ascending order:

1. Ballal Sen
2. Lakshman Sen
3. Hemant Sen
4. Vijaya Sen

A. 4, 3, 2, 1 B. 2, 1, 4, 3 C. 1, 2, 3, 4 D. 3, 4, 1, 2

Show answer

Correct Answer: **D** (3–4–1–2 / Hemant Sen → Vijaya Sen → Ballal Sen → Lakshman Sen) **Detailed Explanation:** The correct ascending chronological succession of the Sena rulers of Bengal is: 1. **3. Hemant Sen (late 11th century):** Son of Samantasena; founded the independent principality in Radha (West Bengal) as Pala suzerainty waned. 2. **4. Vijaya Sen (c. 1095–1158 CE):** Real architect of the Sena Empire; defeated Madanapala, drove the Palas out of northern and western Bengal, took imperial titles (*Parama-mahesvara*, *Ariraja-vrishabha-sankara*), and established capitals at Vijayapura and Vikramapura. 3. **1. Ballal Sen (c. 1158–1179 CE):** Consolidated Bengal and Mithila; introduced *Kulinism* (social stratification system); compiled major socio-religious works including *Danasagara* and *Adbhutisagara*. 4. **2. Lakshman Sen (c. 1179–1206 CE):** Last prominent Hindu monarch of Bengal; initiated the *Lakshmana Samvat* era in 1179 CE; patronized celebrated Sanskrit poets including Jayadeva (*Gita Govinda*) and Dhoyi; fled his secondary capital Nadia when Bakhtiyar Khalji launched a surprise attack in 1204 CE. **Mnemonic / Exam Trap:** - Remember the succession order via **H–V–B–L** (Hemant → Vijaya → Ballal → Lakshman). - A common trap is placing Ballal Sen before Vijaya Sen or confusing Hemant Sen with the feudatory progenitor Samantasena.

1.14 Paramara Dynasty



Region:Malwa | **Capital:Dhara** (earlier **Ujjain**) | **Peak:Bhoja I (c. 1010–1055)**, scholar-king

- Paramaras rose as **Pratihara feudatories** and fought **Kalachuris** for control of Malwa.
- Dynastic start is linked with **Upendra / Krishnaraja** in the 9th century; **Siyaka II** is often called the real founder of Paramara power. Capital settled at **Dhara**.
- **Bhoja I** patronised Sanskrit learning and is the archetype scholar-king of **Dhara**.
- His works include *Samarangana Sutradhara* (architecture and mechanical / scientific devices), *Sarasvatikanthabharana*, *Siddhanta Sangraha*, *Rajamartanda*, *Yukti-kalpataru*, *Charucharya*, and related texts.
- He established **Bhojshala** at **Dhar (1035)** as a Sanskrit school whose presiding deity is **Saraswati** (सरस्वती) (later associated with the Kamal Maula mosque premises).
- The **Samidheshwar / Tribhuvan Narayan** temple at Chittor (चित्तौड़) is linked with Paramara **Bhoja**.
- After Bhoja's death, scholars remembered Dhara as "waterless" and Saraswati as unsupported — a famous mourning verse on learning's collapse.
- **Munja** and **Udayaditya** are other Paramara names; **Gangeyadeva** is **Kalachuri**, not Paramara.
- **Rajasekhara**, author of **Kavyamimamsa**, served the **Pratihara** court, not Bhoja's Paramara court.
- Paramara architecture and learning mark **Malwa**.
- **Padmagupta** (पद्मगुप्त) wrote *Navasahasankacharita* (नवसाहसांकचरित) on Paramara origin (king **Sindhuraja** (सिन्धुराज)). **Merutunga** (मेरुतुंग) wrote *Prabandha Chintamani* (प्रबंध चिंतामणि). The **Udaipur Prashasti** (उदयपुर प्रशस्ति) is another Paramara source.
- They must not be confused with Bundelkhand temples of the Chandelas.

> **Logic:** Dhara / Malwa = Paramara**.** Khajuraho = Chandela**.** Mihir Bhoja ≠ Paramara Bhoja**.**
> **Bhojshala deity =** Saraswati**.

1.15 Chandela Dynasty

Region:Bundelkhand (Jejakabhukti) | **Span:** c. **9th–13th c.** | **UP facts:Mahoba**, **Kalinjar (Banda)**

- **Nannuka (~831)** is the founder of the Chandela line in Bundelkhand.
- The region's ancient name **Jejakabhukti** comes from **Jeja / Jayashakti**, grandson of Nannuka. Do **not** match Jejakabhukti with **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी).
- Chandela chronology spine: **Yasovarman (925–950)** → **Dhanga (950–1002)** → **Vidyadhara (c. 1017–1029)** → **Kirtivarman (c. 1060–1100)**.
- **Dhanga** is the classic **Khajuraho** (खजुराहो) temple patron. Tradition says he abandoned his body at the **Ganga–Yamuna (यमुना) sangam** at Prayagraj (प्रयागराज).
- **Kandariya Mahadeva** (कंदरिया महादेव) at Khajuraho is the Nagara-style showpiece; it is usually dated to **Vidyadhara's** reign (many MCQs still park it under Dhanga's Khajuraho age).
- **Vidyadhara** resisted Ghaznavid (ग़ज़नवी) pressure and is the Kalinjar-age Chandela peak.
- **Parmardi / Paramardi (c. 1165–1203)** fought **Prithviraj Chauhan**.
- His Mahoba commanders **Alha** and **Udal** are remembered in folk (लोक) epic. The Chauhan–Chandela struggle appears in Chand Bardai's *Prithviraj Raso* and in Jagnik's *Alha-khand* (*Parmal Raso*).

- Khajuraho (UNESCO WHS (यूनेस्को)) belongs to the **Chandelas**, not Paramaras or Pratiharas.
- **Mahoba** and **Kalinjar** place the dynasty on the **UP–MP Bundelkhand** frontier tested by UPPCS.

> **Logic:** Assign **Khajuraho → Chandela**. **Jejakabhukti = Bundelkhand**. **Alha–Udal = Mahoba**, not Chanderi/Panna.

1.15a Chauhan, Tomar & Solanki (Pre-Medieval north-west)

Chauhans (Chahamanas) of Ajmer–Delhi

- **Prithviraj III** is the famous **Prithviraj Chauhan** of Ajmer.
- **First Tarain (1191):** he defeated **Muhammad Ghori**.
- **Second Tarain (1192):** Ghori defeated and captured him — full Cause→Course→Result cards sit in Turkish Invasions Topic 2.
- **Vigraharaja IV** was the earlier Chauhan peak who conquered the Tomaras and annexed **Delhi** / eastern Punjab.
- *Hammira Mahakavya* presents Chauhans as **Suryavanshi** scions of Chahamana and as one of the four **Agnikula** clans. Early names include Vasudeva and Guvaka.
- *Hammir Raso* is by **Sharangadeva** (not Abdur Rehman).
- *Prithviraj Raso* is by **Chand Bardai**. *Prithviraja Vijaya* is by **Jayanaka**. *Visaldev Raso* is linked with **Narpati Nalha**.

Tomaras of Delhi

- **Anangpal Tomar**, originally a Pratihara feudatory, founded **Dhillika (Delhi)** in the **8th century**.
- Later Chauhan power absorbed Delhi before the Ghurid (गौर) breakthrough.

Solankis / Chaulukyas of Gujarat

- Agnikula Chaulukyas / Solankis were founded in power by **Mularaja I**.
- Capital was **Anhilwada (Anhilwara / Patan)**.
- Jain scholar **Hemachandra** rose under **Jayasimha Siddharaja (1093–1143)** and later advised **Kumarapala (1143–1172)**.
- **Jayasimha Siddharaja** is remembered for restoring a demolished mosque at **Khambhat** with a large grant (Aufi's account).

> **Logic:** Delhi founder = **Tomar Anangpal**, not Chauhan. Solanki capital = **Anhilwada**, not Dhara.

1.16 Gahadavala Dynasty

Capitals:Kannauj (political) + **Banaras / Varanasi** (religious-economic) | **Span:** 11th–12th c. UP–Bihar doab

- **Chandradeva (~1090)** founded independent Gahadavala power at Kannauj after Pratihara collapse.
- **Madanapala (~1100–1114)** consolidated the early Gahadavala base in the doab.
- **Govind Chandra (~1114–1154)** was the greatest Gahadavala ruler.
- Persian (फ़ारसी) praise placed his territory from **Mongyr to Delhi**.
- His queen **Kumaradevi** was Buddhist and built the **Dharmachakra Jaina Vihara** at **Sarnath**.
- His minister **Lakshmidhara** wrote *Krityakalpataru*.
- **Vijay Chandra (~1154–1170)** ruled during the intermediate phase before Jay Chandra.
- **Jay Chandra (~1170–1194)** was the last major Gahadavala ruler and rivalled **Prithviraj Chauhan** over status and territory in the doab.
- **Muhammad Ghori** killed **Jay Chandra** at **Chandawar (1194)** and took Kannauj.
- The Gahadavalas patronised **Sanskrit learning** at Banaras.
- They held **Kannauj** as their political capital alongside Banaras.
- Kannauj never regained imperial stature after Turkish conquest of the Ganga valley.

> **Logic:** Jay Chandra dies at **Chandawar 1194**, not Tarain (**1192**, Prithviraj). **Kumaradevi's vihara = Sarnath**, not Bodh Gaya (बोधगया).

PYQ — Gahadavala dual capitals

1. Assertion (A): The **Gahadavalas** held **Kannauj** and **Kashi** (काशी) as dual centres of power.

Reason (R): **Kannauj** was the political sovereignty seat while **Kashi/Banaras** was the major religious-cultural centre.

A. Both true, R explains A B. Both true, R not explanation C. A true, R false D. A false, R true

Show answer

Correct Answer: **A** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** The Gahadavalas (founded by Chandradeva in the late 11th century) maintained twin urban anchors in Uttar Pradesh: **Kannauj (Kanyakubja)** served as their political/imperial sovereign capital, while **Varanasi (Kashi)** served as their prestigious second/cultural capital and religious seat. - **Reason (R) is correct:** The middle Gangetic doab between Kannauj and Varanasi commanded the most fertile agricultural alluvial belt in northern India as well as the prime riverine transit routes (*Ganga trade artery*), yielding immense agricultural revenue and strategic geopolitical dominance. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The dual control of Kannauj (conferring traditional pan-Indian royal legitimacy) and Kashi (monopolizing pilgrim revenue, religious prestige, and eastern Gangetic commerce) formed the integrated economic and geopolitical foundation that enabled the Gahadavalas to dominate Uttar Pradesh for over a century until the Battle of Chandawar (1194 CE). **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Gahadavalas are explicitly called the kings of *Kanyakubja* and *Kashi* in their epigraphs. - Chandawar (1194 CE), where Jayachandra was defeated by Muhammad Ghori, is located near modern Firozabad/Etawah in Uttar Pradesh.

1.17 Kalachuri Dynasty

Region:Tripuri near **Jabalpur** (Dahala / **Chedi** belt) | **Peak rulers:Gangeyadeva**, **Karna**

- Kalachuris of Tripuri are often called **Chedi** or **Dahala** Kalachuris in textbooks.
- **Gangeyadeva** expanded Kalachuri power and clashed with the **Paramaras of Malwa**.
- He adopted the title **Vikramaditya** and revived **gold** coin (मुद्रा) issues after a long gap in the pre-medieval north.
- **Al-Biruni** describes Gangeyadeva and his capital **Tripuri**.
- **Karna** continued the conflict with Paramaras and left strong coin and temple records.
- The Kalachuri capital was **Tripuri** near Jabalpur. Do not match it with Paramara **Dhara**, Chandela **Khajuraho**, or **Kannauj**.
- Their rise forms part of the wider **Rajput regional state** map after Pratihara decline.

> **Logic:** Tripuri / Jabalpur belt = Kalachuri**.** Gangeyadeva ≠ Paramara**. Do not park them at Dhara or Mahoba.

1.18 Hoysala Dynasty

Capital:Dvarasamudra / Halebid | **Span:** c. **1026–1343** | **Style:Vesara** (Dravida + Nagara (नागर) blend)

- **Vishnuvardhana** was the dynasty's great builder and turned strongly to **Vaishnavism** under **Ramanuja (विशिष्टद्वैतवाद)'s** influence.
- **Hoysalesvara** at Halebid and **Chennakesava** at **Belur** (बेलूर) are the signature Hoysala monuments.
- Hoysala temples used **soapstone** and are famous for dense exterior sculpture.
- Hoysalas rose under Western Chalukya shadow (छाया), then fought Cholas and later Deccan rivals.
- **Veer Ballal** was a **Hoysala** ruler of Dvarasamudra/Halebid.

> **Logic:** Halebid/Dvarasamudra = Hoysala. Not Warangal, not Devagiri.

1.19 Kakatiya Dynasty

Capital:Warangal (Orugallu) | **Span:** c. **1083–1323** | **Peak:Ganapati Deva** | **Rudramadevi**

- **Ganapati Deva** expanded Kakatiya power into coastal Andhra and built the core Warangal fortifications.
- **Rudramadevi** ruled as **Rudradeva** in inscriptions.
- She was a woman ruler recorded under a male royal name.
- The dynasty is famous for **fort walls**, gateways, and **tank irrigation** networks in Telangana.
- The Kakatiya capital was **Warangal (Orugallu)**. Do not match it with Yadava **Devagiri**.

- **Motupalli** (present **Prakasam** district, Andhra Pradesh) was a famous Kakatiya seaport. Marco Polo visited through this port and wrote of Andhra prosperity.
- The Motupalli epigraph lists assessed rates on sandal, camphor, rose-water, ivory, pearls, coral, copper, zinc, lead, silk, pepper, and areca — a window on exports and imports.
- Ganapati Deva's Motupalli charter protected sea merchants.
- Kakatiya power fell to Delhi Sultanate pressure in the early **14th century**.

> **Logic:** The Kakatiya capital was **Warangal**. **Motupalli** was their famous seaport, not Masulipatnam or Kakinada.

PYQ — Rudramadevi

1. Assertion (A): **Rudramadevi** ruled the **Kakatiya** kingdom.

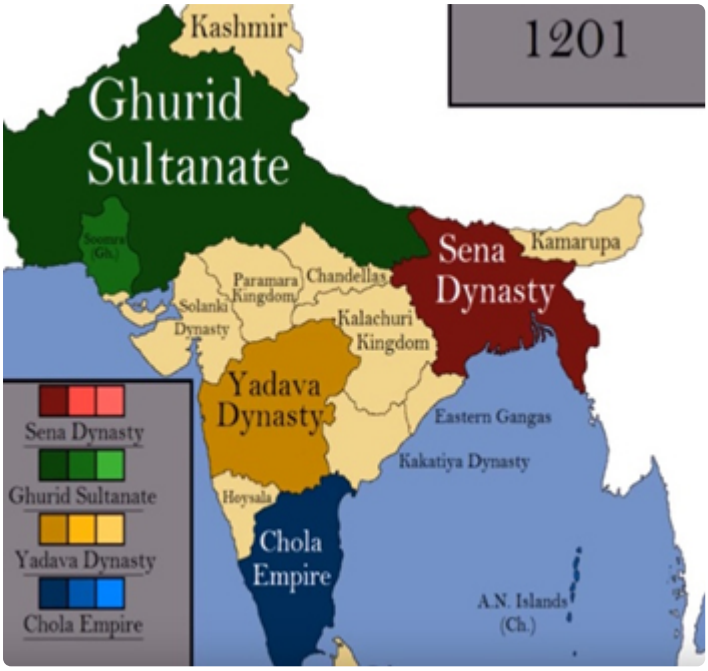
Reason (R): Inscriptions record her under the royal name **Rudradeva**.

A. Both true, R explains A B. Both true, R not explanation C. A true, R false D. A false, R true

Show answer

Correct Answer: **A** (Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Assertion (A) is correct:** **Rudramadevi** (reigned c. 1262–1289 CE) was one of the few prominent female sovereigns of medieval India, ruling the **Kakatiya kingdom** of Warangal with exceptional administrative, military, and defensive prowess. Venetian traveller Marco Polo, who visited Motupalli during her reign, lavishly praised her justice and governance. - **Reason (R) is correct:** In accordance with the wishes of her father Ganapati Deva (who had no surviving sons), Rudramadevi was formally initiated into kingship through the male coronation ceremony (*Putrika ceremony*) and is officially referred to as **"Maharaja Rudradeva"** in numerous stone epigraphs across Telangana and Andhra. - **Why (R) explains (A):** The historical fact that contemporary epigraphs issue royal edicts under her designated masculine throne name (*Rudradeva*) directly substantiates and validates her sovereign rule over the Kakatiya realm in official legal records. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Rudramadevi belongs to the **Kakatiya dynasty of Warangal**, not the Yadavas of Devagiri or Hoysalas of Halebid. - Her prime overseas commercial port was **Motupalli** (celebrated for Marco Polo's visit).

1.20 Yadava Dynasty



Capital:Devagiri (later **Daulatabad**) | **Span:** c. **1187–1317** | **Peak:Singhana** | late ruler **Ramachandra**

- The Yadavas promoted **Marathi** as a court language alongside Sanskrit.
- **Singhana** is remembered as the dynasty's strong early ruler of the Devagiri line.
- **Ramachandra** submitted to **Alauddin Khalji (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी) in 1296** after Khalji's Deccan campaigns.
- The dynasty finally ended in **1317** under Delhi Sultanate pressure.
- **Devagiri** later became **Daulatabad**.
- That link appears in Sultanate capital-shift questions.
- **Devagiri** is the **Yadava** capital.
- It must not be matched with Kakatiya **Warangal**.

> **Logic: Devagiri** was the **Yadava** capital. **Warangal** was the **Kakatiya** capital. **Ramachandra** was a Yadava ruler of Devagiri, not a Kakatiya ruler of Warangal.

PYQ — NOT correctly matched

1. (UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q96) Which of the following pairs is **NOT** correctly matched (State–Ruler)?

A. Devgiri (देवगिरि)–Shankar Dev B. Warangal–Ramchandra Dev C. Hoysal–Veer Ballal D. Madura–Veer Pandya

Show answer

Correct Answer: **B** (Warangal — Ramchandra Dev is NOT correctly matched) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Pair A: Devgiri — Shankar Dev (Correctly matched):** Singhana's lineage; Shankaradeva (Singhana II) was the son and successor of Ramachandra of the **Yadava dynasty of Devagiri**, who resisted Malik Kafur's expedition in 1312 CE. - **Pair B: Warangal — Ramchandra

Dev (INCORRECTLY matched):** **Ramachandra Dev** was the famous king of **Devagiri (Yadava dynasty)**, who submitted to Alauddin Khalji in 1296 CE. The contemporary ruler of **Warangal (Kakatiya dynasty)** during the Sultanate invasions was **Prataparudra II** (who surrendered the Koh-i-Noor diamond to Malik Kafur in 1310 CE). - **Pair C: Hoysal — Veer Ballal (Correctly matched):** **Veera Ballala III** (c. 1292–1342 CE) was the prominent Hoysala monarch of **Dvarasamudra (Halebid)** who fought the Sultanate armies. - **Pair D: Madura — Veer Pandya (Correctly matched):** **Vira Pandya** was involved in the Pandyan succession struggle with Sundara Pandya at **Madurai**, which prompted Malik Kafur's invasion of the far south in 1311 CE. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Match key Deccan rulers during Alauddin Khalji / Malik Kafur's campaigns: - **Devagiri (Yadava):** Ramachandra Dev & Shankar Dev - **Warangal (Kakatiya):** Prataparudra II - **Dvarasamudra (Hoysala):** Veera Ballala III - **Madurai (Pandya):** Vira Pandya & Sundara Pandya

1.21 Medieval Names of Cities of Uttar Pradesh

Modern / common	Medieval / classical name	Key fact
Kannauj	**Kanyakubja**; **Mahodaya / Mahodaya Shri / Nagar Mahoday Shri**	Harsha capital; tripartite prize; Mihir Bhoja / later Gahadavala
Ayodhya	**Saketa**	Ancient–medieval continuity in Awadh
Varanasi (वाराणसी)	**Kashi / Banaras / Avimukta**	Gahadavala secondary capital; sacred centre
Mahoba	**Mahotsava Nagar** (also Mahoba)	Chandela capital in Bundelkhand **UP**
Kalinjar	Kalanjar fort	Chandela stronghold, **Banda** district
Aligarh	**Koil**	Early medieval name for the Aligarh belt
Bundelkhand	**Jejakabhukti**	Chandela country — **not** Kaushambi

- **Kannauj** was Harsha's old capital and the tripartite sovereignty prize.
- **Kashi / Banaras / Avimukta** was the Gahadavala religious-cultural centre, not the same role as Kannauj.
- The standard ancient–medieval name pair for Awadh is **Ayodhya** and **Saketa**.
- **Mahoba** and **Kalinjar** tie Chandela power to **Bundelkhand, UP**.
- Do not confuse **Kannauj (UP)** with **Kanchi (TN)**.
- Do not match **Jejakabhukti** with **Kaushambi**.

> **Logic:** Medieval UP place names to memorise: **Kannauj**, **Kashi**, **Ayodhya**, **Mahoba**, **Kalinjar**, **Koil**, and **Jejakabhukti** (Bundelkhand).